

Commerce scan

What this tool produces · *A street-level diagnostic report featuring mapped anchor institutions, business density metrics, vacancy rates, and pedestrian footfall counts.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Economic

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *Commerce scan*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Treating the commercial street not as a static row of buildings, but as a living organism whose pulse can be measured through the rhythmic flow of pedestrians and the diversity of its shopfronts.

Evidence we produce

A street-level diagnostic report featuring mapped anchor institutions, business density metrics, vacancy rates, and pedestrian footfall counts.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 to 3 weeks for field research and mapping

Material · Base maps, field survey sheets, footfall counters, local tax assessor databases

Reference case

Fareham Borough Council conducts bi-annual Retail Health Checks to classify units and measure vacancy rates. By visually logging whether retail properties are active, vacant, or transitioning, the council utilizes this data to monitor the effectiveness of zoning policies and adapt to out-of-town retail competition over time.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) › Method walk-through (15 min) › Animation canvas (60-90 min) › Harvest (20 min)

Storefront × type × vacancy × foot-traffic

Duration
2 to 3 weeks for field research and mapping

Address	Type	Vacant?	Frontage (m)	Foot-traffic	Notes

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.